YO TOURS · AUDIO GUIDE

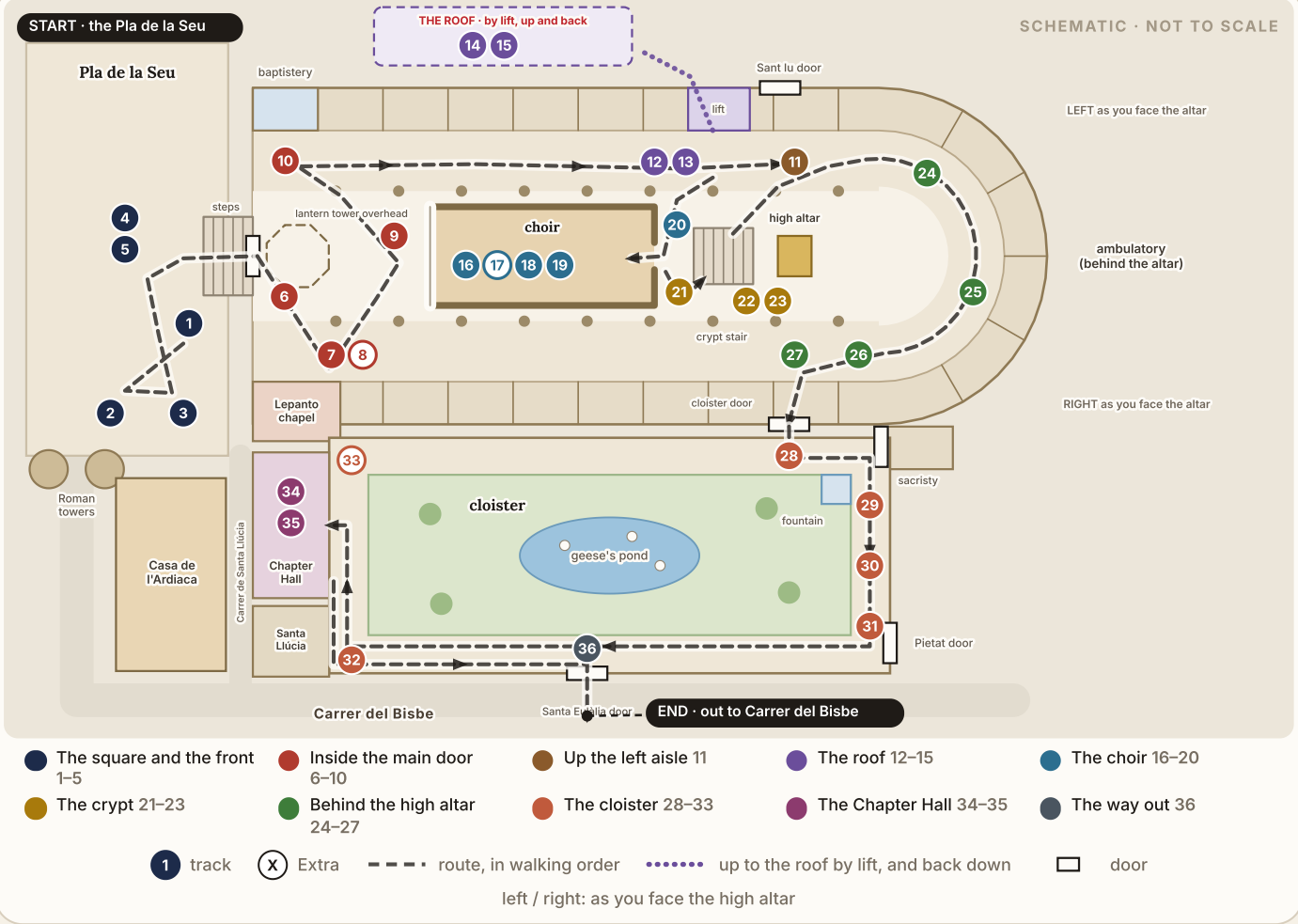
Barcelona Cathedral

The cathedral of the Holy Cross and Saint Eulàlia, la Seu (not the Sagrada Família): 33 main stops plus 3 short Extras on one route, from the square to the cloister door, in three lengths.

1 **One route, directions at every step.** The square and the front first, then in at the main door, up to the roof by lift, the choir, the crypt, behind the high altar, the cloister and the Chapter Hall, and out at the Santa Eulàlia door.

2 Each circle is the track to play there; hollow ones are short Extras. Every track ends by telling you where to go next. Pages 2–4 say where to stand for every track.

3 **A working church.** Headphones, voice low. If Mass is on, the Lepanto chapel is heard from its doorway, and the choir and the crypt from their entrance or the top of the stair.



1 Full tour

≈ 1 h 30 · 36 tracks

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20 21 22 23 24 25 26 27 28 29 30 31 32 33 34 35 36

every stop and all 3 Extras: the square, the roof, the choir, the crypt, the ambulatory, the cloister and the Chapter Hall

2 Essential

≈ 1 h · 18 tracks

1 2 4 6 7 9 10 11 12 14 15 18 21 22 29 30 34 36

the square and the front, the Lepanto chapel, the choir screen and the baptistery, the roof, the shields, the crypt, the cloister, the Pietà

3 Highlights

≈ 30 min · 9 tracks

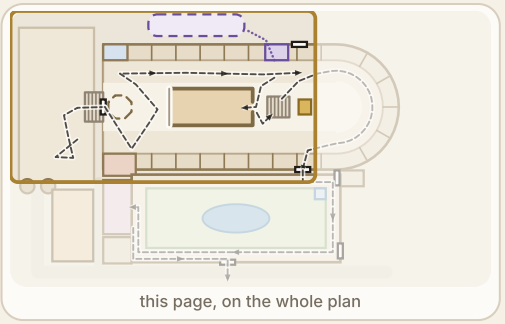
1 4 6 18 22 29 30 34 36

the front, the lantern tower, the Golden Fleece shields, Santa Eulàlia's tomb, the dancing egg, the geese, the Pietà

The roof lift is small: expect a wait; the times above include walking but not the wait. Left and right are always as you face the high altar. Shorter versions: the numbers jump, and a spoken line tells you the next stop.

The square, the main door, the left aisle and the roof · 1–15

The square first, before you go in. Inside, left and right are as you face the high altar. The roof is reached by a small lift beside the Sant Iu door: there may be a queue, and the two lift tracks can be heard in it.



this page, on the whole plan

The square and the front 1–5

On the Pla de la Seu, before you go in: beside the steps, at the end with the two Roman towers, facing the Casa de l'Ardiaca, then far enough back to see the whole front.

1 **Welcome to Barcelona Cathedral** Essential Highlights
The Pla de la Seu · on the square in front of the cathedral, to one side of the steps (heard before you go in)
On the Pla de la Seu, the open square in front of the cathedral, standing to one side of the steps up to the main door so the way stays clear; heard before you go in.

2 **The bishops never moved** Essential
The Pla de la Seu · at the end of the square by the two Roman towers, the cathedral in view
At the end of the square where two old stone towers stand, close to them but clear of the crowd, turned back so the cathedral front is in view.

3 **A square from after the war**
The Pla de la Seu · with the Casa de l'Ardiaca in view, beside the cathedral
On the square, turned towards the old stone house built against the Roman wall beside the cathedral, with its door in view; stay clear of the steps.

4 **Drawn in 1408, built in 1887** Essential Highlights
The facade · on the square, far enough back to see the whole front
On the square facing the cathedral, far enough back to see the whole front from the door up to the spires and the lantern tower behind it.

5 **The design that lost**
The facade · same spot
Same spot on the square, facing the front, far enough back to see the lantern tower rising behind it.

Inside the main door 6–10

Just inside the main door, under the lantern tower: the Lepanto chapel on the right, the choir's white marble screen ahead, the baptistery on the left.

6 **A tower over the door** Essential Highlights
Inside the main door · just inside, to one side, looking along the nave to the choir screen
Just inside the main door, a step to one side so people can come in, looking along the nave towards the marble screen of the choir.

7 **The Christ older than its battle** Essential
The Lepanto chapel · at its doorway, outside; never inside during a service
At the doorway of the chapel of the Christ of Lepanto, close to the main door on the right as you face the high altar; stay outside the doorway, to one side, and never go in during a service.

8 **The bishop under the crucifix** Extra
The Lepanto chapel · at its doorway, outside
Same place, at the doorway of the chapel of the Christ of Lepanto, outside it and to one side; never go in during a service.

9 **The sculptor who never came back** Essential
The choir screen · a few steps back from the white marble screen at the end of the choir, facing it
In the nave, a few steps back from the white marble screen that closes the end of the choir, facing it, with its central door and the carved panels either side in view.

10 **Baptised here** Essential
The baptistery · at the chapel's entrance, the font and its tall window in view
At the entrance of the first chapel on the left as you face the high altar, beside the main door, with the font and the tall stained-glass window in view; stand aside if worshippers are there.

Up the left aisle 11

Up the left aisle to the Sant Iu door, under the organ, beside the lift chapel.

11 **A Saracen under the organ** Essential
The Sant Iu door · inside, near the side door, the organ in the gallery above
Inside the church, near the Sant Iu side door towards the far end of the left aisle as you face the high altar, the great organ in its gallery high above the door; stand out of the way of the door and the lift chapel beside it.

The roof 12–15

Up by the small lift from the chapel of the Holy Innocents, beside the Sant Iu door (there may be a queue), onto the roof terraces, and back down.

12 **Eulàlia strikes the hours** Essential
The lift · in the queue at the chapel of the Holy Innocents, or at the top beside the lift
In the queue for the roof lift at the chapel of the Holy Innocents, beside the Sant Iu door; with no queue, at the top, standing to one side of the lift. Nothing needs to be seen.

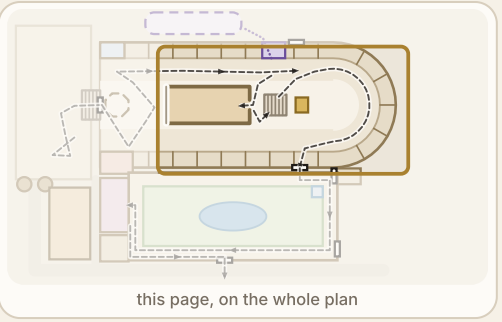
13 **Lightning and firecrackers**
The lift · same place (queue or top)
Same place as the last stop: in the lift queue at the chapel of the Holy Innocents, beside the Sant Iu door, or at the top to one side of the lift. Nothing needs to be seen.

14 **Saint Helena on the lantern** Essential
The roof · on the terraces, the lantern tower over the main door in view
On the roof terraces, on the walkway, with the lantern tower over the main door in front of you and the statue on its top in view; keep to the walkway and out of the way of people passing.

15 **The old town from above** Essential
The roof · where the old town and the cloister are in view
On the terraces, at a spot on the walkway where you can see over the rooftops of the old town and down into the cloister garden.

The choir, the crypt and behind the high altar · 16–27

Back down from the roof to the choir in the middle of the nave, then the crypt stair in front of the high altar, round the ambulatory, and to the white marble door into the cloister. If the choir or the crypt is closed, each track says where to listen.



this page, on the whole plan

The choir 16–20

The wooden enclosure in the middle of the nave. Closed? Listen at its entrance, looking in.

16 **Oak from Bruges**
The choir · inside, among the upper stalls (or at the entrance if closed)
Inside the choir, the wooden enclosure in the middle of the nave, standing where the tall upper row of seats is in view; if the choir is closed, at its entrance, looking in.

17 **Under the canons' seats** Extra
The choir · beside a seat with its folding ledge raised
Inside the choir, beside one of the seats whose folding ledge is already raised, so the carving underneath shows; never lift a seat yourself.

18 **Europe's most exclusive club** Essential Highlights
The choir · inside, where the painted shields above the upper stalls are in view (or at the entrance if closed)
Inside the choir, standing where the row of painted coats of arms above the tall upper seats is in view; if the choir is closed, at its entrance, looking in.

19 **Four days in March**
The choir · same place, among the shields (or at the entrance if closed)
Same place as the last stop, inside the choir with the painted shields above the upper seats in view; if the choir is closed, at its entrance.

20 **A canopy of spires**
The choir · at its entrance, the pulpit beside you, the spires over the stalls in view
At the choir's entrance, beside the wooden pulpit, where you can look up at the carved spires over the upper seats.

The crypt 21–23

The stair down in front of the high altar to Santa Eulàlia's tomb. Closed? Stay at the top of the stair: the tomb is in view below.

21 **Thirteen, according to tradition** Essential
The crypt · at the top of the stair down to the crypt, in front of the high altar
At the top of the stair that goes down to the crypt, in front of the high altar, standing to one side so the steps stay clear.

22 **Two kings on the stairs** Essential Highlights
The crypt · down in the crypt with the tomb in view (or from the top of the stair)
Down in the crypt, standing where you can see the marble tomb, out of the way of the steps; if the crypt is closed, at the top of its stair, with the tomb in view below.

23 **A comic strip in marble**
The crypt · by the tomb, the reliefs on its box in view
Down in the crypt beside the marble tomb, out of the way of the steps, where the carved scenes on its box can be seen; if the crypt is closed, at the top of its stair.

Behind the high altar 24–27

Round the ambulatory, the walkway behind the altar, to the sacristy door and the white marble cloister door, both on the right.

24 **They started at this end**
Behind the high altar · in the ambulatory, the walkway behind the altar, the tall windows in view
In the ambulatory, the curving walkway behind the high altar, standing to one side of the flow where you can look up at the tall windows above its chapels.

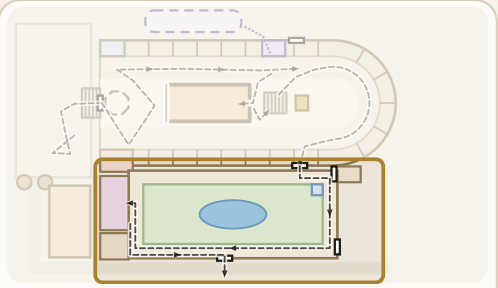
25 **The saint who sailed on his cloak**
Behind the high altar · in the ambulatory, by the chapel with Sant Ramon de Penyafort's tomb
In the ambulatory, at the chapel whose sign names Sant Ramon de Penyafort, with his tomb in view.

26 **The founders who were excommunicated**
The sacristy door · on the right of the high altar, below the two painted wooden coffins high on the wall
Beside the sacristy door, on the right of the high altar as you face it, standing back far enough to see two painted wooden coffins high on the wall.

27 **The summer of 1936**
The cloister door · beside the white marble doorway, inside the church, looking back at the choir
Inside the church, beside the white marble doorway into the cloister, in the bay on the right of the high altar; stand out of the way of the door and turn to look back at the choir.

The cloister, the Chapter Hall and the way out · 28–36

Through the white marble door into the cloister: the fountain, the geese, the Pietat door, the chapel of Santa Llúcia and the Chapter Hall museum beside it, then out at the Santa Eulàlia door to Carrer del Bisbe.



this page, on the whole plan

The cloister 28–33

Through the white marble door: the fountain, the geese's pond, the Pietat door, the chapel of Santa Llúcia.

28 **A door from the older cathedral**
The cloister · just through the white marble door, facing back at it
In the cloister, a few steps beyond the white marble door from the church, turned round to face it and its carved capitals.

29 **The egg the accountant wrote down** Essential Highlights
The cloister · beside the fountain pavilion, near the door from the church, its little vault overhead in view
Beside the small vaulted pavilion over the fountain, in the corner of the cloister near the door from the church, where you can see up into its little vault.

30 **Thirteen geese** Essential Highlights
The cloister · on a walk with the pond in view (the far side if crowded)
On a cloister walk with the geese's pond in view; if it's crowded by the pond, on the walk on the far side of the garden.

31 **A Bible on the capitals**
The cloister · near the Pietat door, a carved capital in view
In the cloister walk near the Pietat door, the door to the street with a Pietà carved above it, where a pillar's carved capital is also in view.

32 **Santa Llúcia, older than the cathedral**
The cloister · at the doorway of the chapel of Santa Llúcia
At the doorway of the chapel of Santa Llúcia, at a corner of the cloister on the same walk as the Chapter Hall museum; stay at the doorway unless visitors are clearly allowed in.

33 **Jewish memory** Extra
The cloister · at the Jewish memory room, the Old Archive of 1535
In or at the door of the room called Jewish memory, the Old Archive of 1535, with its documents on display.

The Chapter Hall 34–35

The museum beside the chapel of Santa Llúcia: Bermejo's Pietà and the great monstrance.

34 **The saint in spectacles** Essential Highlights
The Chapter Hall · in front of Bermejo's Pietà
Inside the Chapter Hall museum, in front of the painted panel of the dead Christ across his mother's lap, Bermejo's Pietà; stand back a little so others can see.

35 **A throne for the Host**
The Chapter Hall · beside the monstrance and the stone font
In the Chapter Hall museum, beside the great gilded monstrance on its silver seat, with the stone font with lobed sides nearby; only what is on display is pointed at.

The way out 36

The cloister's Santa Eulàlia door, out to Carrer del Bisbe.

36 **Seventeen centuries on one corner** Essential Highlights
The Santa Eulàlia door · just inside the cloister's street door, out of the way
Just inside the Santa Eulàlia door, the cloister's door to Carrer del Bisbe, standing to one side so people can pass in and out.

Before you start

A few things to know on the ground. No prices, hours or tickets here: check them with the cathedral before your visit.

Headphones

Listen on headphones, at a volume low enough to hear what is around you. This is a church: no speakers.

Worship and Mass

Barcelona Cathedral is a working church. Hat off and voice low. Never go into a chapel during a service, and take no photos then. Where a service can close a space, the guide says where to listen instead (see below).

The lift wait

The roof is reached by a small lift from the chapel of the Holy Innocents, beside the Sant Iu door, so there may be a queue. The two lift tracks are made to be heard while you wait. The times on page 1 don't include the wait.

Offline

Once the MP3s are on your phone, the guide needs no signal and no data.

Left and right

Inside, left and right are always as you face the high altar. On the square, each track tells you which way to face.

Out of the way

Stand to one side of doors, steps, the lift and the crypt stair; let worshippers and other visitors pass, and let the geese be.

Steps

Steps up to the main door and down into the crypt; walkways and steps on the roof. Watch your step.

Shorter versions

In Essential and Highlights the numbers jump. A short spoken line at the end of a track tells you where the next one is.

If a space is closed, or a service is on

The route never asks you to go into a space during a service. Where a space may be closed, the track tells you where to listen instead.

The Lepanto chapel	007–008	Listen at its doorway, outside and to one side. Never go in during a service.
The lift	012–013	No queue? Play both tracks at the top, to one side of the lift.
The choir	016–020	Closed? Listen at its entrance, looking in.
The crypt	021–023	Closed? Stay at the top of its stair: the tomb is in view below.
The chapels	010, 032	Stay at the doorway if worshippers are there or visitors are not clearly allowed in.
Jewish memory	033, Extra	An Extra, for when the room is open to visitors.

This plan is our own schematic drawing, not to scale, made from the guide's own directions. Where the ground differs, follow the cathedral's signs and staff.